Sejin Sarah Oh

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Education

Hankuk Academy of Foreign Studies *Yongin, South Korea*
Expected Graduation: January 2027

GPA: 4.96/5.00 (unweighted)

Standardized Test Scores: SAT: 1570 / TOEFL iBT: 111 / AP Scores of 5: Calc BC, Lang, World, Euro, US Gov

Research

First Author, *A Historical Analysis on the Landscape of Korean Education*

- Analyzed how Confucian institutions, Japanese colonial administration, state-led industrialization, democratization, and market liberalization shaped modern Korean education.
- Examined the gap between the intended and actual effects of school equalization, private-education restrictions, and post-IMF market reforms.
- Extended the research into a 25,000-word comparative book examining how U.S. and Korean education systems shape students' labor-market opportunities.
- Combined the co-authors' firsthand experiences across Korean and U.S. schools with historical and policy analysis of standardization, educational inequality, private tutoring, and vocational pathways.

First Author, *How Social Media Fuels Populism and Strategies for Counteraction*

- Published in the International Journal of High School Research, 2026. DOI: 10.36838/IJHSR814.47
- Designed and conducted experiments on algorithmic echo chambers, misinformation susceptibility, and populist rhetoric in digital media.
- Analyzed responses from 59 participants assessing the credibility of social-media posts alongside algorithmic echo-chamber experiments and coded populist rhetoric and developed policy recommendations concerning algorithmic transparency, platform accountability, and media literacy.

Contributor, *Where and Why Do the Timorese Migrate? A Gravity Approach and Reference to South Korea*

- Analyzed migrant-worker demographics and remittance patterns in field-survey data from Timorese migrant workers in South Korea using STATA regression and gravity-model frameworks
- Found that Korea's Employment Permit System had greater explanatory power than geographic distance, supporting an institutional explanation of migration patterns associated with the institutions hypothesis.
- Main contributor to "Where and Why Do the Timorese Migrate?" published in Nakhara: Journal of Environmental Design and Planning (NJEDP), presented findings at ACBES (8th Asian Conference on Business and Economic Studies) in Hanoi.

Work

Jinjigwan (Cooking for Charity) | Yongin, South Korea
Head Chef, Co-Founder, and Co-President | Aug. 2025 – Present

- Co-founded and managed a 45+ member student nonprofit that has raised and donated $6K+ through 6+ campus bake sales to support 170+ children with disabilities across five regions.
- Negotiated a memorandum of understanding with Save the Children and oversaw menus, recipe development, procurement, production, finances, and member training.
- Earned placement on Yongin's Human Network Talent Donation Portal and national coverage from Veritas Alpha and Korea Disabled News.

Korea Federation of Disability Organizations (KOFDO) | Seoul, South Korea
Accessibility Policy Research Intern *Mar. 2026 – Present*

- Compared electric-wheelchair reservation, documentation, and carriage policies across 10+ domestic and international airlines; findings informed KOFDO Policy Report Vol. 470.
- Built a structured disability-policy archive and verified AI-assisted research against original sources for KOFDO's 2026 annual report.
- Produced event documentation and supported operations for disability-employment and advocacy programs.

Graduate School of International Studies (GSIS) at Ewha Womans University | Seoul, South Korea
Independent Researcher and Research Assistant *Jan. 2024 – Dec. 2024*

- Applied gravity models, institutional economics, and labor migration theory; used STATA for statistical analysis, including data cleaning, regression analysis, and interpretation of empirical results
- Assisted the research on Timorese labor migration to South Korea by analyzing field survey data from migrant workers and cleaned survey responses to organize the dataset.

Model United Nations | Seoul and Yongin, South Korea
President; Co-Founder/Secretary-General, *Mar. 2024 – Present*

- President of UNITED (Daewon Foreign Language High School Model United Nations Society)
- Co-founded MUN Without Borders, a community outreach program teaching MUN through partnerships with 6+ public libraries, culminating in a youth MUN conference; reached 100+ Yongin children
- Chaired and organized various conferences including DMUN, MUN4Charity, MIMUN, SYMUN, DLMUN; received awards at Korea Univ. MUN, Sogang Univ. MUN, UN Association of Rochester, Hilton MUN.

BEACON (Daewon Foreign Language High School Newspaper) | Seoul, South Korea
President and Editor-in-Chief, *Mar. 2024 – Mar. 2025*

- Led Daewon's only English-language newspaper and managed a staff of 50+ student writers.
- Published 10,000+ words on child welfare, conflict, political philosophy, and technology ethics; also wrote for the Korea Youth Press Corps.

Volunteering

Gangnam Lifelong Education Center for Individuals with Developmental Disabilities | Seoul, South Korea
Teaching Assistant, Jan. 2025 – Present

- Provided one-on-one academic, communication, and activity support to adults with developmental disabilities during lifelong-education classes; adapted instruction to participants' cognitive, behavioral, and communication needs.
- Served as the center's only high-school volunteer.

Gifted Class of Hankuk University of Foreign Studies | Yongin, South Korea
Mentor, Mar. 2025 – Present

- Designed and taught introductory French, philosophical thought experiments, WSDC debate, and international relations to classes of 10–15 elementary and middle-school students.
- Taught 100+ students across two summer camps and developed discussion, writing, and simulation-based lessons.
- Supervised students as a residential group leader during 15-hour daily camp schedules.

Kineme, Youth Theater | South Korea
Actress, Playwright, Assistant Director, and Sound Engineer, Mar. 2025 – Present

- Wrote and performed nonverbal adaptations of Korean folktales through Kineme, presenting accessible charity performances for deaf children at the Cheoin Welfare Center for Individuals with Disabilities.
- Co-wrote an original METEOR production examining academic competition and student well-being in Korea; managed sound and assisted with directing before an audience of 150+.

Awards & Honors

- National Merit Semifinalist, 2026
- 2nd Place, International History Bowl (IHBB) Korea Varsity; Captain, 2025
- 2nd Place, National History Day Korea; Group Website Division, 2026
- 2nd Place, SAGE Korea, selected to represent Korea at SAGE Global, 2026
- Honorable Mention (Top 4), Korean Philosophy Olympiad (KPO), 2026
- 3rd Place/Semifinalist, 64 teams and 200+ participants, Cornell International Summer Debate Camp, 2023
- Grand Prize, Think-Tank Ultimatum (HAFS Research Competition), 2025
- Best Screenplay Award, 25th Yangsan National Youth Theater Festival (writer/sound engineer), 2025
- Outstanding Witness, Korea Mock Trial Association (KMTA), 2026